

Data Center and the Environment

Posted by u/RegretPowerful246 • 0 points • 11 comments

They are building a data center 20 minutes from me. I feel like I could cry. How bad is the light pollution? I moved out to the rural country side because I wanted inky black night sky and I feel that's going to be robbed from me in a few years.

Should I worry about water usage. I'm agriculture and although I'm very mindful about water conservation, I'm worried about the well long-term.

Comments

u/Human_Struggle_675 • 0 points • 2025-02-07 22:46 UTC

Don't believe what people are telling you. I guarantee you the light pollution will be so bad you will have bright colored lights shining in your bedroom window keeping you awake all night.

Forget trying to grow any plants or livestock. The weird lights that come from data centers will screw up your plants or animals. They won't know if it's day or night.

The water usage is a very big concern. Data centers are also used to cover up toxic waste disposal. They just flush toxic chemicals down the drain and into streams and rivers.

u/Dandelion-Blobfish • 1 points • 2025-02-07 10:05 UTC

What region are you in? Most data center designs have gone to closed loop systems that don't consume significant water, but your region would make it easier to confirm or deny that possibility.

If you're worried about light pollution, you can always mention it to the city council, show up for zoning hearings, etc., but as others have mentioned, data center light pollution should be relatively minimal (certainly not like many large industrial plants)

u/RegretPowerful246 • 0 points • 2025-02-07 12:45 UTC

There is a town hall meeting mid February that I plan on attending so I could get information directly from the source.

u/JoeBigg • 6 points • 2025-02-07 05:36 UTC

After the construction is done you will not know it exists.

u/RegretPowerful246 • 2 points • 2025-02-07 12:43 UTC

That's reassuring. Thank you

u/Physical_Aside_3991 • 3 points • 2025-02-07 05:33 UTC

Zero light pollution. Parking lot & maybe a few cars. It'll be busy as fuck during construction & then just a silent hum, if that.

u/I_ROX • 4 points • 2025-02-07 05:26 UTC

Datacenters normally have minimal windows for light to escape and are not high traffic, so lighting in parking areas and buildings will be minimal. The only natural resources would be solar and natural gas. If anything, your electric company may bolster their grid in the area.

u/RegretPowerful246 • 0 points • 2025-02-07 12:44 UTC

We already have a ton of brown outs in this area. They urge people to keep their ac at 80 when it's 110 outside. I don't have high hopes.

u/Downhill_Sprinter • 1 points • 2025-02-09 17:53 UTC

The data center coming locally may help to enforce better power infrastructure, which the general population would also benefit from.

u/looktowardward • 9 points • 2025-02-07 05:20 UTC

Light pollution is pretty minimal - they are going to light their parking lot at normal lumens for safety. There is no way you'll be able to see it 20 minutes away.

On the water side - they're almost certainly not using well water. That would be extremely unusual.

\> I feel like I could cry

You're using Reddit. How do you think Reddit works, exactly?

u/RegretPowerful246 • -2 points • 2025-02-07 12:42 UTC

I'm upset that 440 acres of agriculture land, in a county known for agriculture is being sold off and used for "cloud storage" instead of viable attempts to re-energize the rural economy.

u/looktowardward • 1 points • 2025-02-08 01:15 UTC

Please. You just want the data center near someone else.